

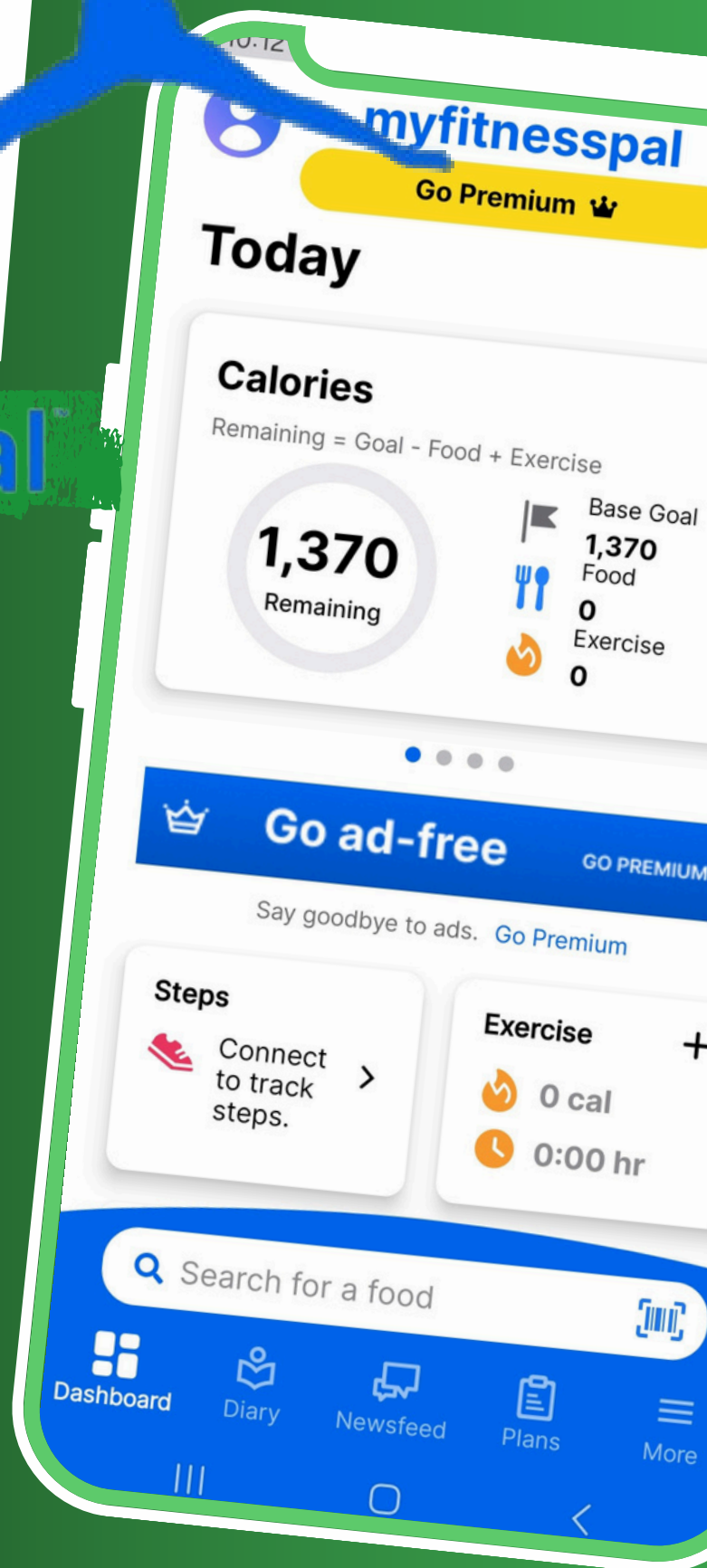
NEW

myfitnesspal

THE BEGINNERS GUIDE TO MY FITNESS PAL



PEAK FITNESS DIEPPE



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Hey! Welcome.

If you're reading this guide, then you're interested in learning more about how the the new MyFitnessPal APP can help you reach optimum nutrition for both health and fitness goals - and that's awesome.

In 2023, MyFitnessPal decided to introduce an incredible update to the APP, and thanks to this APP, we have some incredible new features that give us so much more power over how we take control of our exercise, nutrition, and overall lifestyle.

Whether you are a person who loves to track their nutrition, exercise or participate in a variety of diets, this app will help you with every aspect of that. The previous version of the APP was completely free to use and there were very little limitations. However, MyFitnessPal has decided to monetize a lot more of the features in 2023. So, now we have a free and a premium version.

In this guide we will focus on all the features, but we'll keep it specified which one is free and which one is premium. Then, you can decide which version suits you better.

We hope that you enjoy this guide! Let's get started.

Before, you go any further, you're going to need to download the APP.



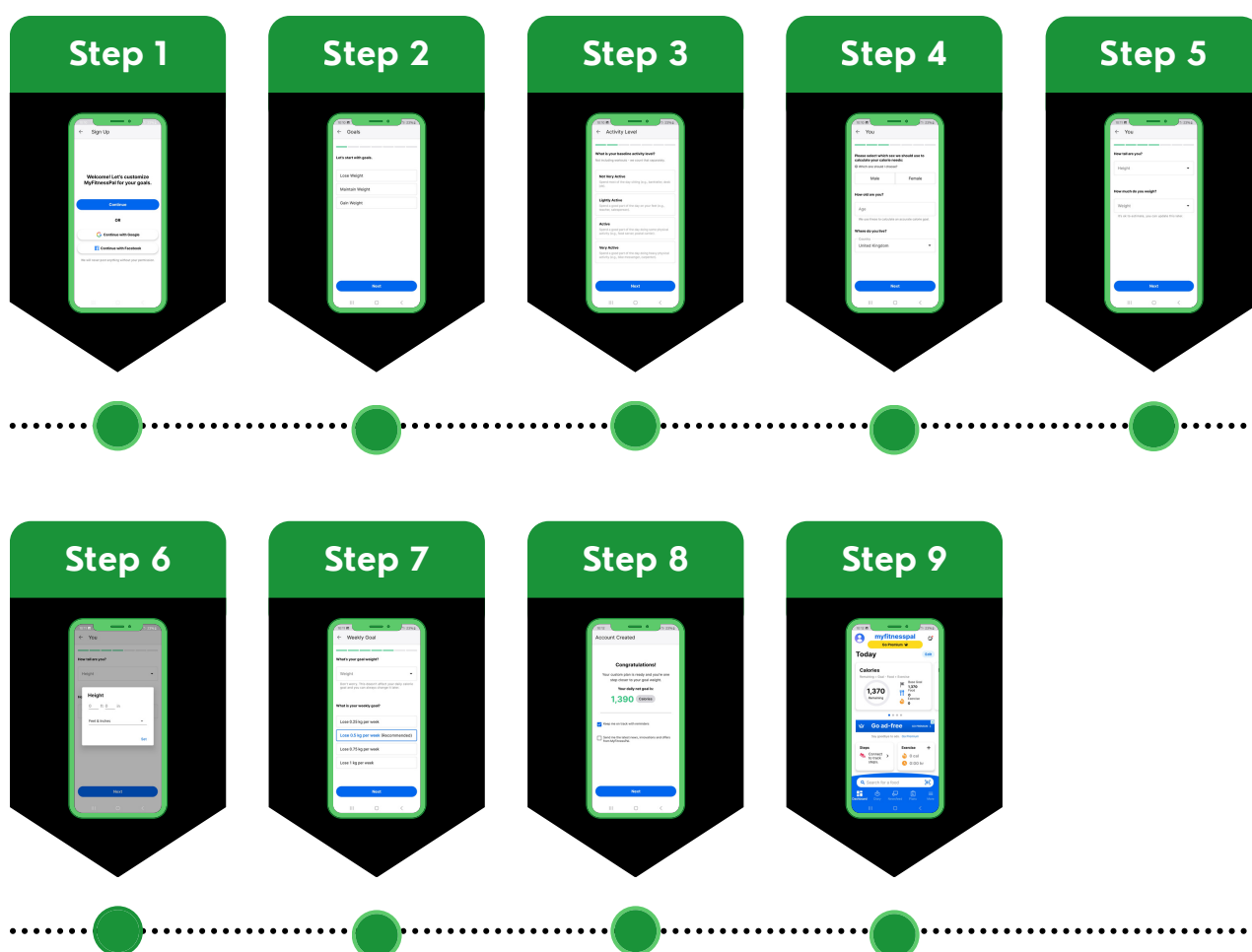
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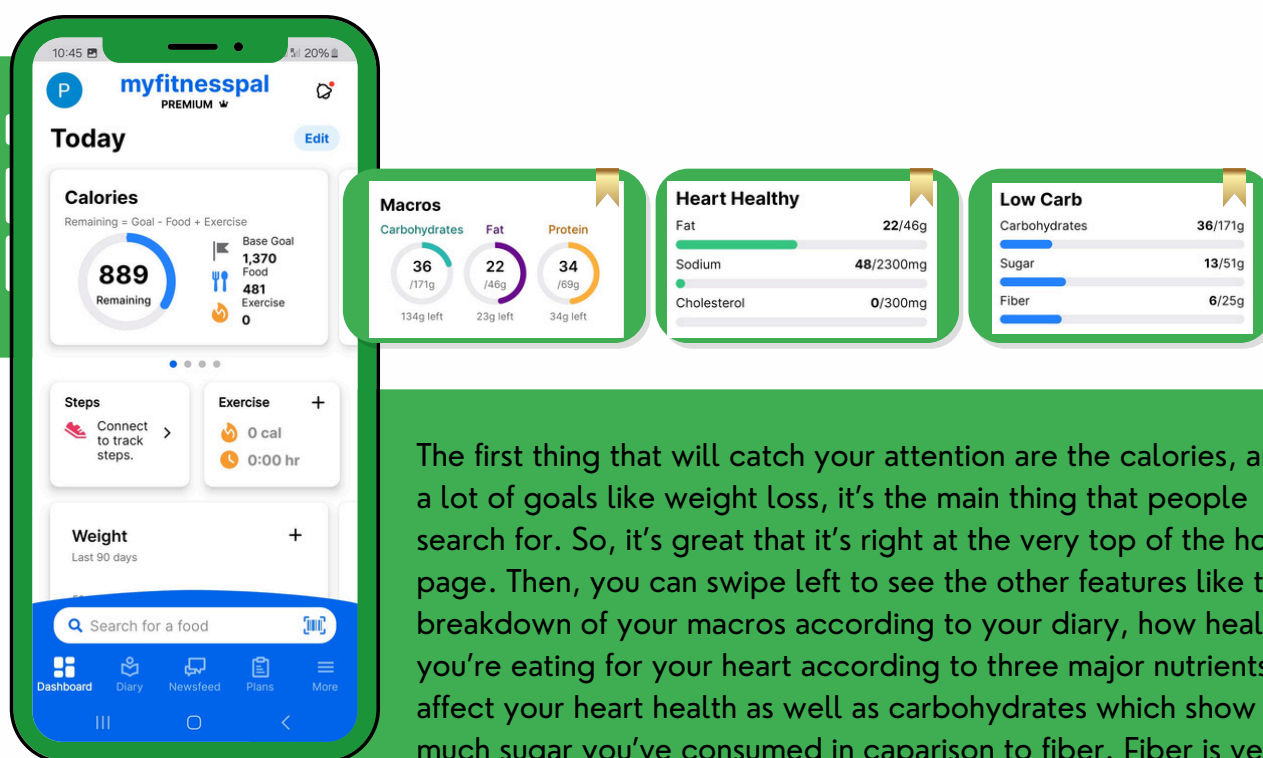
The Set Up

Once you download the APP, you'll be asked a variety of questions in terms of your body composition (height, weight), goal, and much more. This is your chance to be as honest as you possibly can as MyFitnessPal uses this information to create the most accurate profile for you with recommendations for calorie intake and macronutrients. Based on this information, it can also predict how many calories you've lost during certain exercises.

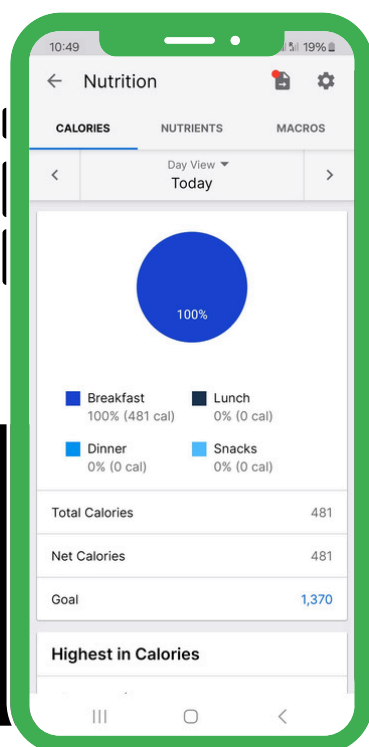


The Home Page

The new version of MyFitnessPal has a very streamlined home page. From here, you can access pretty much everything from nutrition, exercise, steps and health information.



The first thing that will catch your attention are the calories, and for a lot of goals like weight loss, it's the main thing that people search for. So, it's great that it's right at the very top of the home page. Then, you can swipe left to see the other features like the breakdown of your macros according to your diary, how healthy you're eating for your heart according to three major nutrients that affect your heart health as well as carbohydrates which show how much sugar you've consumed in comparison to fiber. Fiber is very important for our digestion, immune system and regular bowel movements. Whereas too much sugar can lead to insulin spikes, insulin resistance and mood swings. So, it's great that MyFitnessPal has recognised the importance of tracking these things. When you insert food into your food diary, all these features will be automatically updated.

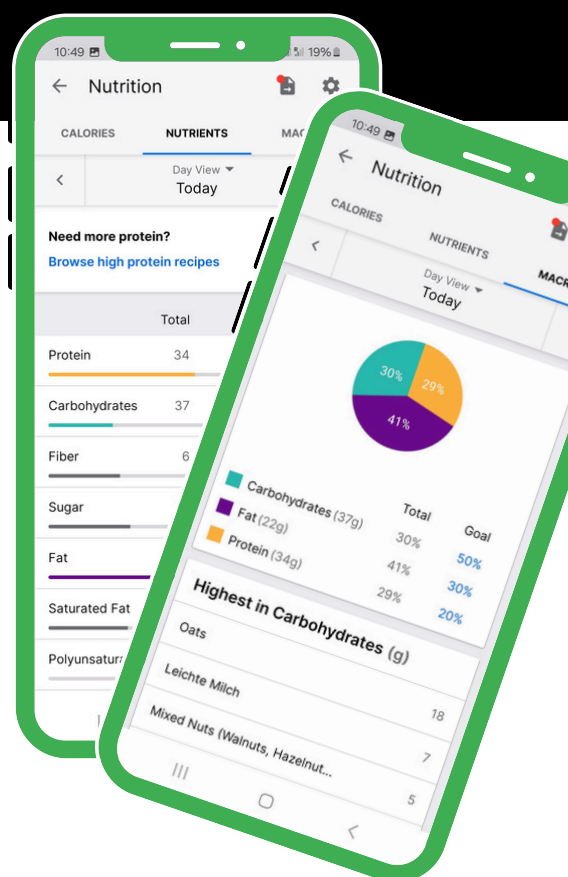


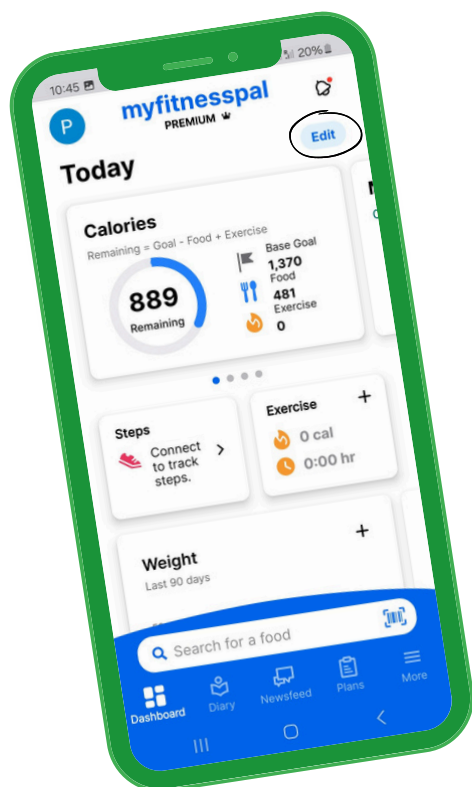
When you click on your calories, you'll be able to view a full breakdown of your calories for each meal. Right now, we only entered breakfast so the chart is fully blue. However, when you enter the foods for each meal, the chart will automatically change and you'll be able to view information for each meal.

At the top of this page, you'll find different tabs; Nutrients and Macros. When you click on these tabs, you'll find a more in-depth breakdown in terms of nutrients you've consumed like vitamins, minerals, protein, fat and carbohydrates.

The view of macronutrients on the home page is for premium subscribers only, so clicking on these tabs can be a little workaround to view your food diary analysis. These pages are incredible for showing you exactly how well you're eating and sticking with your goal as you're eating each meal. This gives you a chance to make changes throughout your day as you need. For example, if you notice that you're not getting enough vitamin D, then you can consume more fish or if you feel that you're consuming too much of carbohydrate then you can make your next meal carb-free.

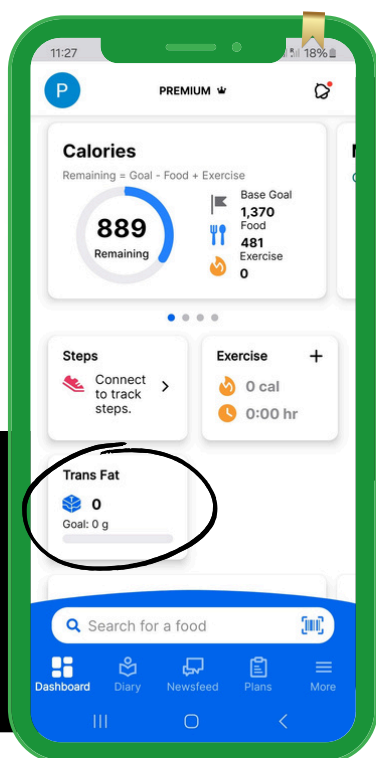
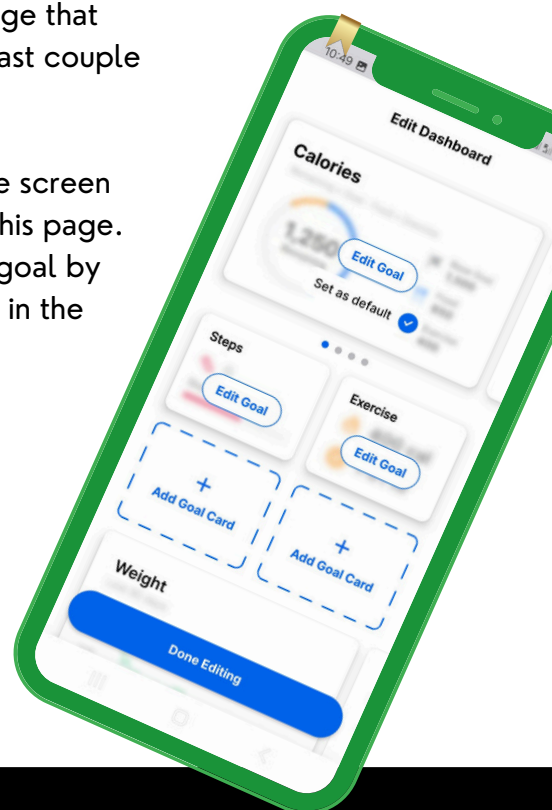
MyFitnessPal sets your macronutrient percentages automatically according to their default settings. This can be changed if you are a premium subscriber. When you first subscribe your nutrients will be broken down into 50% carbs, 30% fat and 20% protein. If you want to change these percentages, you'll need to purchase the premium subscription.





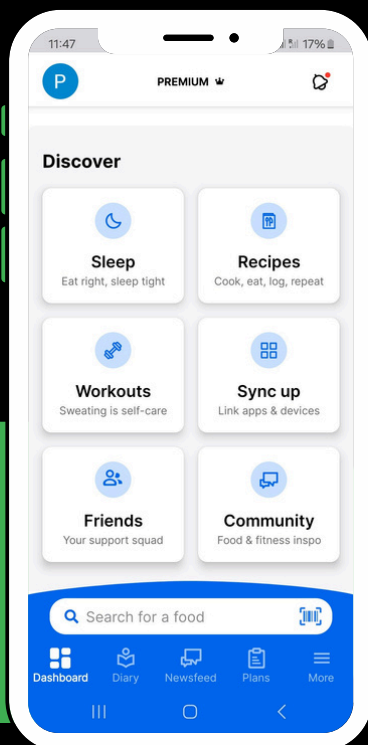
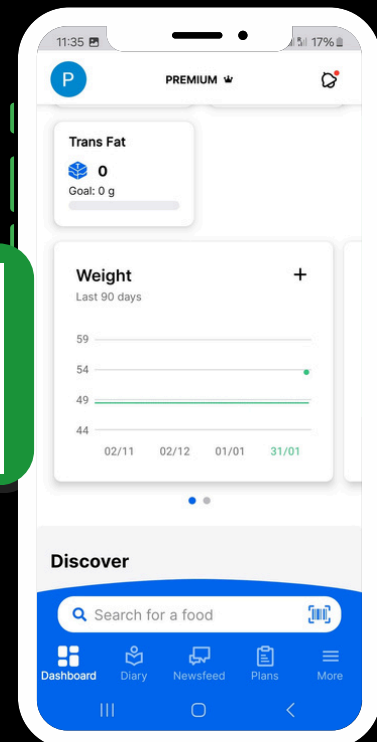
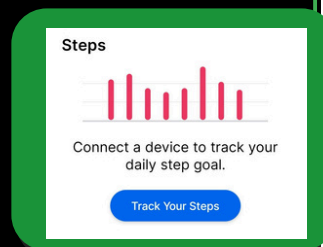
However, if you already have the premium version then you can click on the edit button at the top of the home page that we've been discussing over the last couple of pages.

That's when you'll be taken to the screen shown on the right hand side of this page. This is where you can edit every goal by simply clicking 'edit goal' button in the middle of each goal section.



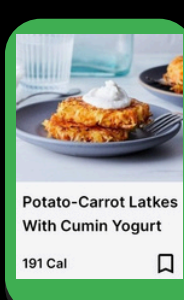
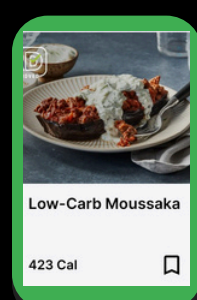
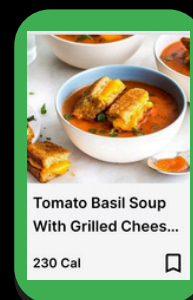
One powerful thing that MyFitnessPal have added is the ability to add your own goals. When you click on the 'Add Goal Card' at the bottom of this page, you'll be able to track all kinds of different nutrition goals. And what's even better? When you add the goal card, it will automatically appear in your homepage as shown on the left screen. However, please remember that this is, again, a premium feature.

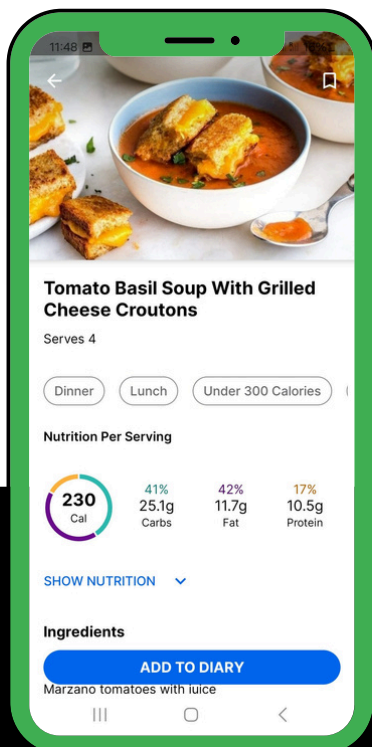
As you scroll lower on the home page, you'll find a chart for your 'weight'. This chart will show you how your weight changes over a number of days. This is also great for viewing your weight fluctuations. You can also swipe to the left and view how many steps you did on a given day. However, you'll need to connect an APP to MyFitnessPal for this to work. When you click on the 'Track Your Steps' button, you'll be given options of different apps like Fitbit, health connect, Garmin, and many more.



At the very bottom of the home page, you'll find some great resources. For example, if you want to know how your food is affecting your sleep, you'll need to set up 'health connect'. But it's a great thing to see if you're struggling with apnoea or other sleeping disorders.

On the right side, you'll find recipes. You can click on that section to get access to all kinds of delicious recipes that are high protein, low-carb, pre-workout, post-workout, vegetarian, gluten-free, and so much more.



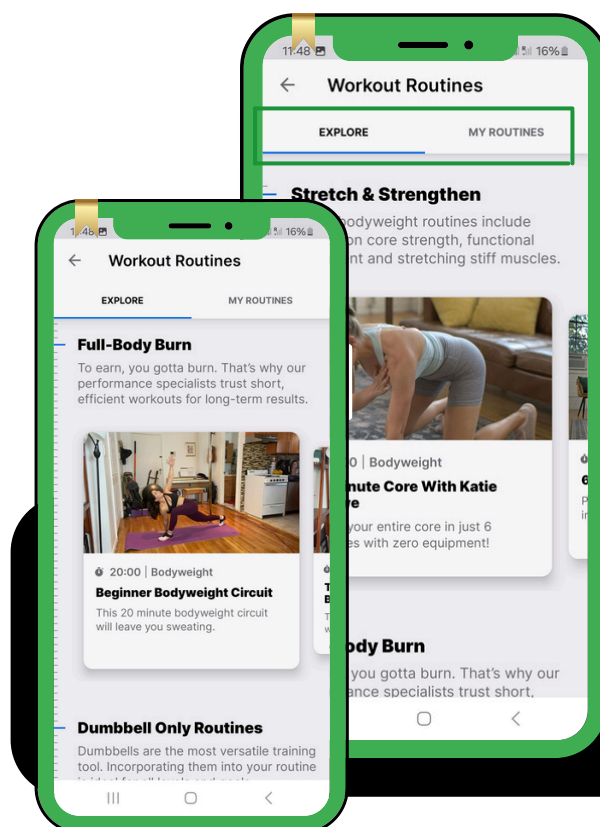


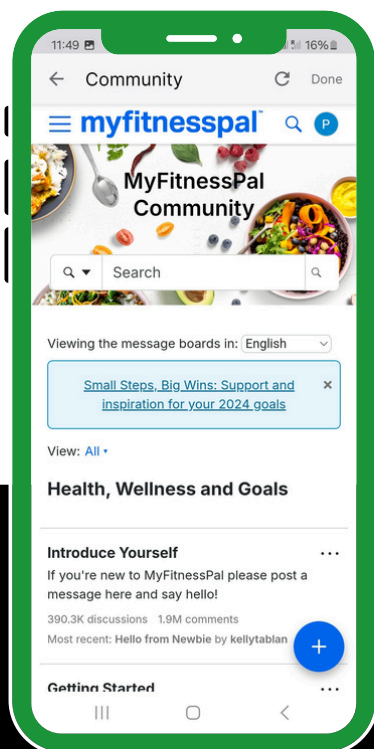
When you click on a recipe, you'll be taken to a full recipe with a breakdown of calories and macronutrients, ingredients list and directions. At the bottom, you'll find a button which enables you to add this recipe to your food diary, and your nutrition section will be automatically updated based on these recipes.

Going back to the bottom of the home page, in the 'discover' section, you'll also find workouts. In this section, you'll find a variety of workouts including:

- Dumbbell-only routines
- Full body burn
- Stretching and yoga
- HIIT blasts
- Full body kettlebells, and much more

When you click on the workouts, you'll be taken to a breakdown of the workout as well as a video demonstration. To access these workouts, you'll need to have a premium subscription.



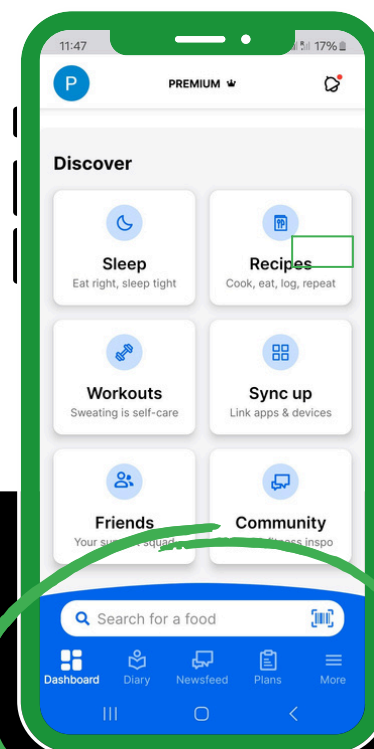


The three remaining options are for syncing up other apps to My Fitness Pal, connecting with your friends using your phone contacts and checking out the community. The community is a great place where you can share your progress, introduce yourself and connect with likeminded people. It's really great for motivation and accountability.

At the very bottom of the home page, you have a menu bar. This is an incredible menu bar that can take you to all kinds of useful places. Here's what you need to know:

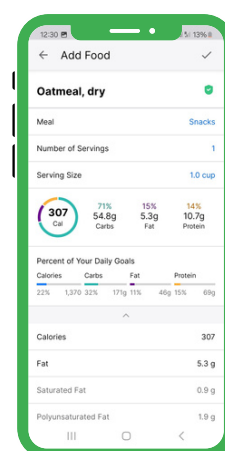
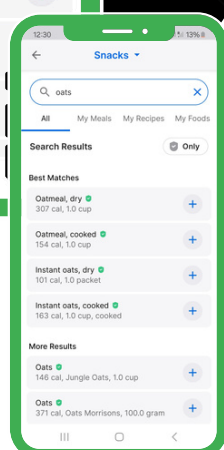
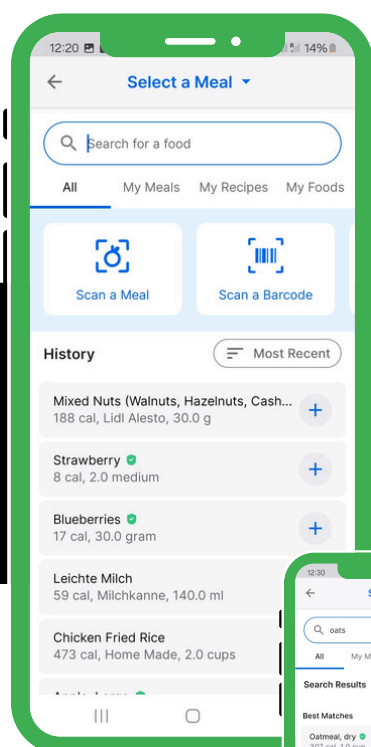
- You can use the search bar to enter new food
- You can click on the 'diary' to be taken to a full breakdown of meals and nutrients for given days
- Newsfeed takes you to the MyFitnessPal Blog
- Plans is where premium subscribers can access a variety of fitness plans, nutrition plans and meal plans.

We'll go over these over the next few pages for the premium subscribers.



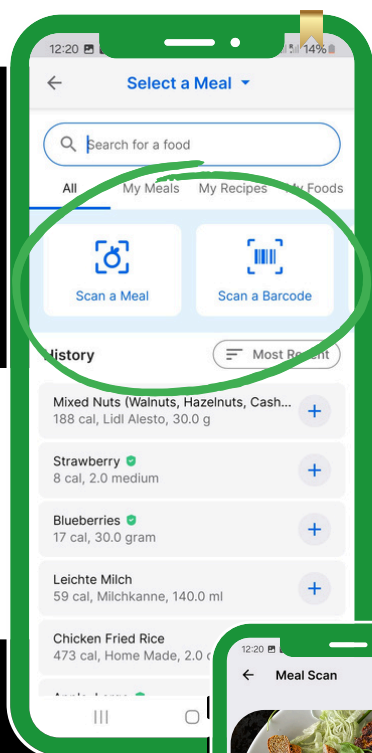
LOGGING FOOD IN THE FOOD DIARY

The easiest way to log your food diary is by using the search bar in the menu at the very bottom of the APP. When you click on 'search for a food', you'll be taken to this page. At the bottom, you can see your history which you can choose again. This is particularly useful if you like to eat the same things. However

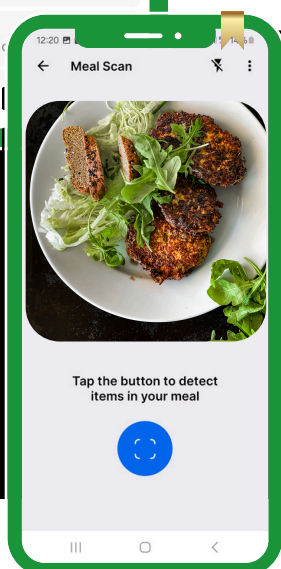


When you enter the food you're searching for, you'll be able to see all kinds of different options. If you want to be accurate, be sure to be as specific as possible by including a brand a full name of the product. You can either click the plus button on the right to automatically add to your diary, or you can click on the food name and adjust the portion/serving size.

This is the screen that you'll get when you click on the food name. Here, you can adjust which meal this ingredient or product is to be added to, number of servings and a total serving size. When you click on the tick at the top of the page, this product or ingredient are going to be automatically added to your food diary.

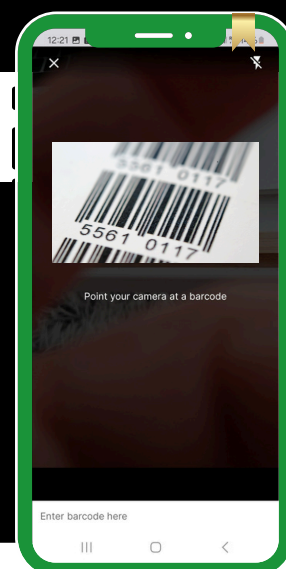


The options that we discussed above are considered to be 'old-fashioned' according to the new MyFitnessPal APP. Going back to the original screen of logging a meal, you'll find two very interesting options - 'scan a meal' and 'scan a barcode'. These options are incredible and it may be possible that they are more accurate for logging your meal nutrition.



The first option is for scanning a meal. If you ever cook a proper meal but forget (or can't be bothered) to write down all the ingredients, then you can simply put the camera in front of a meal and let MyFitnessPal analyse it for you! Once it scans your meal, it will give you an estimation for its calories, macronutrients and nutrients, and if you're happy with all the information, you can automatically save it into your diary!

The second option is by scanning a barcode. This is particularly useful if you cannot find a particular product in the search bar. You can simply scan the bar code, and MyFitnessPal will get all the nutrition facts for you. This can save you so much more time than if you had to insert all the nutrition facts yourself.



Great food choices for each macronutrient.

LEAN

PROTEIN PLANT-BASED

- Tofu
- Tempeh
- Edamame
- Lentils
- Beans
- Hummus
- Peanuts, almonds
- Pea or hemp
- protein powders

MEAT AND POULTRY

- Chicken
- Turkey
- Lean Beef
- Lamb
- Venison
- Eggs

SEAFOOD

- Shrimp
- Mussels
- Crab and lobster
- Calamari
- Octopus

FISH

- Salmon
- Cod
- Herring
- Trout
- Mackerel

DAIRY

- Natural Yogurt
- Milk
- Cottage Cheese



VEGETABLES

- Cabbage Varieties
- Carrots
- Cauliflower
- Celery
- Cucumber
- Kale Lettuce
- Mushrooms
- Spinach
- Mixed bell peppers
- Bean sprouts
- Beets
- Broccoli
- Brussel sprouts
- Turnip
- Greens
- Collard greens
- Radishes
- Okra onions, leeks, shallots
- Tomatoes
- winter squash
- pumpkin
- Zucchini
- Courgette

HEALTHY FATS

COLD-PRESSED OILS

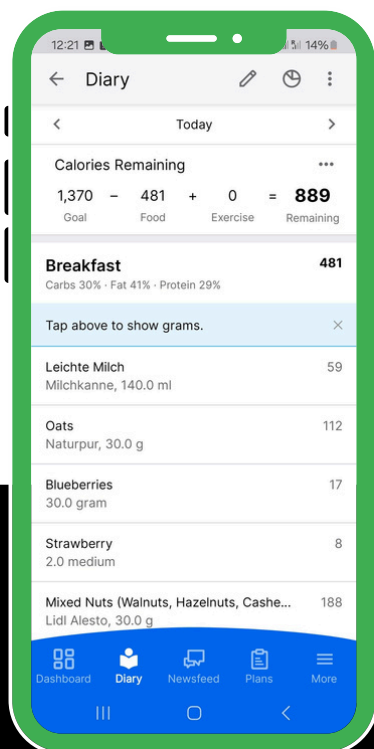
- Flaxseed oil
- Extra virgin oil
- Avocado seed oil
- Fish oil
- Hempseed oil
- Walnut oil
- Coconut oil

NUTS AND SEEDS OTHER FATS

- Almonds
- Cashews
- Walnuts
- Hazelnuts
- Brazil nuts
- Pecans
- Eggs
- Avocado
- Dark chocolate
- Cheese
- Chia seeds

CARBOHYDRATES

- Apples
- Bananas
- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Raspberries
- Cantaloupe
- Cherries
- Cranberries
- Currants
- Grapefruit
- Mangoes
- Melons
- Oranges
- Watermelon
- Oats
- Potatoes
- Quinoa
- Prunes
- Pulses
- Pumpkin
- Buckwheat
- Taro
- Beetroot
- Cassava
- Brown, red, or wild rice
- Amaranth
- Sorghum
- Couscous
- Spelt



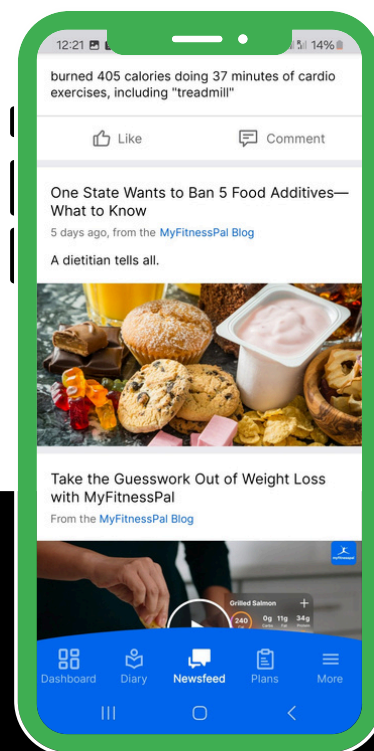
VIEWING THE FOOD DIARY

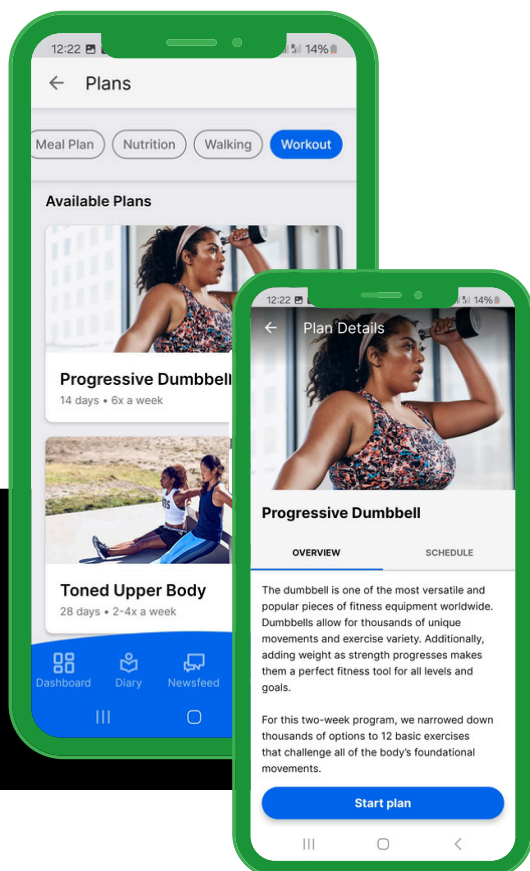
Using the bottom menu bar, simply click on the 'diary' option to be taken to your food diary.

At the top of your food diary, you'll be able to see your goal calories, how many you've already consumed, how many you lose during exercise and how many calories you can remaining for the rest of the day.

When you scroll down the food diary, you'll have a full breakdown of all the meals (breakfast, lunch, snacks and dinner, as well as the individual calories for each.

The newsfeed button on the menu bar takes you directly to the MyFitnessPal blog where you can read about some great information in terms of nutrition, fitness, exercise, and much more. It's a great place where you can learn a lot more about the things you're unsure about.





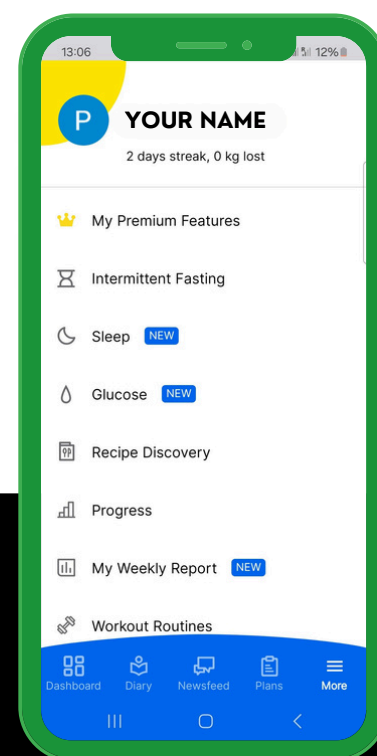
The 'plans' button on the menu bar takes you to a page where you can find a variety of nutrition plans, meal plans, workout plans, and fitness challenges. Most of these options are for premium subscribers but there are some available for people on the free subscription.

When you click on a given challenge, you'll be given a schedule and a full breakdown of the challenge. Some challenges give you a breakdown for each day, and others for each week, but it all depends on the duration of the challenge. If you're just starting a health and fitness journey, and you don't know where to start, THIS IS THE PLACE!

MORE

The very last button on the menu bar is called 'more'. Under this option, you're going to find everything that you can find on the home page, plus a few additional options like settings, your profile, messages, reminder settings, and privacy settings.

There is one new premium feature that is not available on the home page, and that is intermittent fasting. We'll discuss that further on the next page.

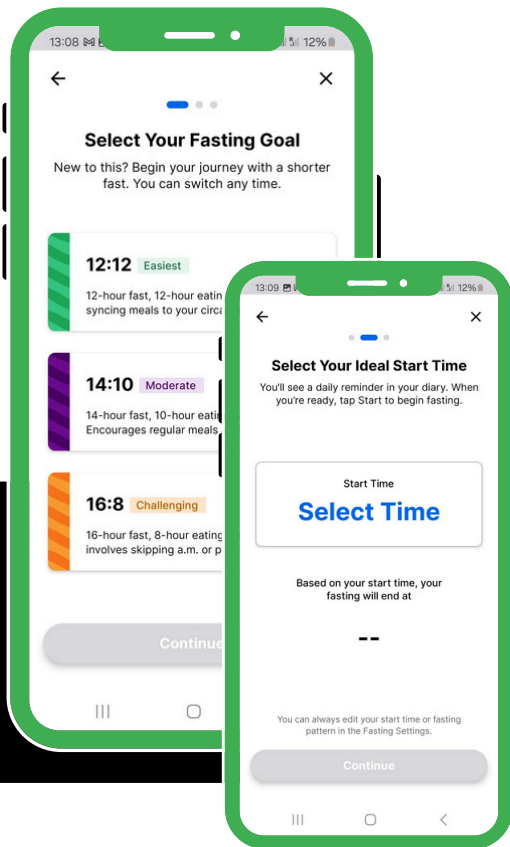


Intermittent Fasting

Intermittent fasting (IF) is an eating pattern that alternates between periods of eating and fasting. Unlike traditional diets that focus on specific foods to restrict, intermittent fasting primarily revolves around when you eat. The concept behind IF is to cycle between periods of eating and non-eating, promoting various physiological and metabolic changes in the body. While there are several methods of intermittent fasting, the most common ones include the 16/8 method, where individuals fast for 16 hours and have an 8-hour eating window, and the 5:2 method, involving two non-consecutive days of consuming a very limited number of calories per week.

The underlying mechanism of intermittent fasting involves tapping into the body's energy reserves during the fasting period. In the absence of recent food intake, the body switches from utilizing glucose as its primary energy source to burning stored fats for fuel. This metabolic shift leads to increased ketone production, which can have various health benefits, including improved insulin sensitivity and enhanced fat burning. Additionally, intermittent fasting may trigger cellular repair processes, such as autophagy, where cells remove damaged components, contributing to overall cellular health. Moreover, intermittent fasting is associated with various health benefits, including weight loss, improved blood sugar control, and reduced inflammation, making it a popular and flexible approach for many individuals seeking a sustainable and effective way to manage their health and weight.

In general, there are various reasons why people get into intermittent fasting, but it's a great tool for fat loss and health improvement. With the new update, MyFitnessPal has decided to include an intermittent fasting tracker to it. What it does is just helps you stay on track with intermittent fasting.



You can track three popular intermittent fasting options and select your starting time. \then, MyFitnessPal counts down the time for fasting for you so you know exactly when you've started and never have to guess yourself again.

When the timer stops, you'll receive a notification to say that your fasting period has been completed. If you have a busy lifestyle and you struggle to manage your time properly, this is a great option. Let MyFitnessPal do the planning work for you.

Voi La!